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Senate of Virginia Floor Session, Monday, February 2, 2026

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[00:27:58] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia. The Senate will come to order. The senators will

[00:30:24] please take their seats. Those persons not entitled to the privileges of the floor will retire to the gallery. The senators and all in attendance will please stand if you are able and be led in prayer this morning by the Reverend Carson Rhine, Presbyterian minister in Richmond, Virginia. And the Pledge of Allegiance will follow. Please remain standing. Our Pledge of Allegiance will

[00:30:52] be led by senate page evelyn nazarino from fairfax let us pray almighty and gracious creator we bow this day in deep gratitude grateful for the lives and opportunities you place before us to serve others but this day particularly we are grateful for first responders police fire rescue electrical linemen, hospitals, snow removers and all who've enabled us to endure the past 10 difficult weather

[00:31:29] days. Through the storms we've experienced the incredible uncommonly wealthy lives we enjoy, the common assistance of neighbors and friends for any need is, the checking in on the elderly or challenged people in our lives, the provisions of shelter and food for those in need, all of which are clear indications of the wealth we often take for granted realizing it cannot be measured in dollars and cents true wealth in our lives or relationships we enjoy with so many and without these kind simple and even heroic efforts by every citizen the commonwealth of

[00:32:08] virginia would not be the gift it is for each of us so today oh god be with the men and women leaders in this chamber guide them in wisdom demonstrate through them civility that gets the work done enable them to model true leadership regardless of which side of the aisle they sit empower them to move forward with the commitment to advance the Commonwealth we all enjoy as they advance the work of the Commonwealth of

[00:32:36] Virginia bless them in their leadership amen the clerk will call the roll all

[00:33:34] those present will please vote aye the clerk will close the roll you have a quorum. Madam President, Senate Journal for Friday, January 30th, 2026. The senator from Hampton moves that the reading of the journal be waived. All in favor of waiving the reading of the journal will record their votes. Aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 31, nos 8.

[00:34:14] Ayes 31, noes 8. The reading of the journal is waived. The clerk will report any communications from the House of Delegates. The chair recognizes the senator from Eastern Fairfax. Good afternoon, Madam President.

[00:34:29] Good afternoon. Madam President, I move the waived reading of the communication from the House of Delegates. The question is, shall the reading of the communication be waived? All in favor of

waiving the reading of the communication from the House of Delegates will record their votes aye, those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote?

[00:34:45] Have all the Senators voted. Do any Senators desire to change their votes? The Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 33, noes 7. Ayes 33, noes 7. The reading is waived. The Clerk will report any communications from the Governor. We do not have any Madam President. We've now arrived at the time of the morning hour when we have the honor of visit welcoming our distinguished guest here in the here in the Senate gallery

[00:35:23] And I give my daily reminder about our procedure. A senator will rise and provide an introduction for their visitors. I will then offer the welcome of the Senate. And I ask that we all hold our applause until I've completed the Senate's welcome.

[00:35:43] The chair recognizes the senator from Richmond City. Thank you, Madam President. I rise for the purpose of an introduction. The senator has the floor. Madam President, I want to thank and introduce our minister for the morning that offered the invocation. The Reverend Ryan is a native of Charlotte, North Carolina. Having come to Virginia in 1990 to begin two new congregations, he served as general presbyter and stated clerk for the

[00:36:16] presbytery of the James in Central Virginia until his retirement in 2018. Since then, He has served as interim pastor for six congregations. He's also served as adjunct faculty at Union Presbyterian Seminary for 25 years teaching church government.

[00:36:36] He is an ordained Presbyterian minister for over 50 years. Thank you, Madam President. I thank the Senator for that introduction and welcome again, Reverend Ryan. Thank you so much for your words of prayer and devotion this morning. Thank you especially for recognizing all those individuals, our first responders, our groups who have been assiduously working to ensure that there is safety for our communities through the challenges of the recent ice storm that we've experienced.

[00:37:09] Thank you for your prayers. Thank you for joining us this morning. Senate, I ask that we give the warm welcome of the Senate to the Reverend Carson Rine. the chair recognizes the senator from Eastern Fairfax oh madam president rise

[00:37:46] for introduction the senator has the floor thank you madam president I have something here to talk about but I don't can't figure where it is but I'm just gonna wing it shall I shall I call you on you a little later no I'm good okay ladies gentlemen Senate join us in the gallery today we have representatives from the Virginia AFL CIO who's here to join us today Virginia AFL CIO represents working people all across the Commonwealth of Virginia and all kinds of lines of work, trades, professions, and businesses. They're here today particularly excited about the docket they're going to be here for this afternoon in the Commerce and Labor Committee meetings,

[00:38:23] a lot of bills they care about there. And then afterwards this evening, they have their annual reception, which I know everybody here is invited to attend. Madam President, if you could please just give them the warm welcome of the Senate. We really appreciate that. I thank the Senator for that introduction and welcome to the Virginia AFL-CIO. Thank you for joining us this morning and thank you for your advocacy. I know you are meeting with many of our legislators and I know today is going to be a very important day in committee for several of the bills upon which you have been working and

[00:38:58] advocating. Senators, I ask that we give the warm welcome of the Senate to the Virginia AFL-CIO. The chair recognizes the senator from Franklin County. Thank you Madam President. I rise for, I don't know if it's an introduction or an announcement, so we'll call it an announcement-duction. How about that? The senator has the floor. Thank you. Members of the Senate, today is your lucky day.

[00:39:33] It's the day that you've been waiting for. When you go back behind that door right over there, there will be a legislative freezer filled with ice cream. Now you gotta sit and you gotta wait until I'm finished. As you enjoy the local ice cream awaiting in those legislative freezers today, please take a moment to recognize the hard-working farm families who made it possible. I want to remind this body that you are tasting the hard work of Virginia dairy farm families. The dairy industry is a cornerstone of our Commonwealth's agricultural economy, contributing over four billion dollars that's billion with a B annually and supporting thousands of local jobs

[00:40:11] across the Commonwealth. By supporting our dairy producers, we aren't just preserving a way of life, we're ensuring that Virginia remains a leader in sustainable food production. These producers work 365 days a year. There is no day off for any ice storm or any snowstorm. And they do that to provide a nutrient-dense, high-quality product while serving as dedicated stewards of our land and of our water. This treat is just a small sample of the world-class quality coming out of our rural communities. Madam President, this ice cream is provided by Homestead Creamery from Franklin County and Madam Clark will remember that for many years I would smuggle ice cream from the

[00:40:51] Homestead Creamery which which was in Franklin County it's in my my home County Frank County. I would come up here with an ice pack full of ice cream just to bring to Madam Clark and and every year her her flavor changed but my dedication to make sure that she had high quality ice cream never did. Homestead Creamery is locally owned dairy produce processing plant nestled among the beautiful Blue Ridge Mountains in Burnt Chimney Virginia which is Franklin County and in fact they now expand their reach into all of Virginia and some North Carolina and other places because this body passed a bill that I had sponsored and wrote called the AFID bill the agriculture forestry industrial

[00:41:30] development bill which helped them to expand they were one of the first ones to get the grant when Governor Bob McDonald was here founded by two local dairy farmers with a shared dream of preserving the family farm for future generations and marketing products directly to consumers, that is the Homestead Creamery.

[00:41:46] And with the help of several local businessmen, their dream became a reality when the Creamery opened its doors in January of 2001. Now celebrating its 25th anniversary, Homestead Creamery is proud to produce high quality glass bottle A2A2 milk and super premium ice cream products.

[00:42:03] Today, the creamery is supported by a network of six local family-run dairy farms dedicated to the health and happiness of their cows and to delivering wholesome, exceptional products to their customers just as they have for a quarter of a century, Madam President. So I say to you, Madam President, the rest of the members, enjoy.

[00:42:21] Thank you, Madam President. And the Dairy Farmers, the Virginia State Dairymen's Association, they may be in the audience, I do not know. But if they are, I'd ask you to extend to them the warm welcome of the Senate. Thank you, Senator. I don't believe we have any members of the Dairy Association present, except for our very own senator, the senator from Shenandoah.

[00:42:47] And I thank the senator for that lovely introduction about ice cream in Virginia. Thank you. The chair recognizes the senior senator from Prince William. Thank you, Madam President.

[00:43:03] I move that we suspend the rules and grant the privileges of the floor to certain distinguished individuals. Thank you, Senator. The question is, shall the rules be suspended and the privileges of the floor now be granted to a distinguished person? All in favor of the motion will record their votes aye.

[00:43:21] Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 39, noes 1. Ayes 39, noes 1.

[00:43:38] the rules are suspended the privileges of the the privileges of the floor are granted the chair recognizes the senior senator from prince william for the purpose of presenting the distinguished guest thank you madam president and i rise for the purpose of an introduction and i'm pleased that my friend and federal partner congressman eugene vindman is here today in richmond with us as you know eugene and his family came to the united states as a refugee from the soviet ukraine when he was just four years old he then served our country in the army for 25 years and he's gone from refugee to representative now that's the american dream

[00:44:15] we all believe in um he's now proudly represents the seventh district of virginia which stretches from 11 localities in central and north areas of the commonwealth and in congress he serves on the u.s armed services committee the u.s house agriculture committee and he has spent the last year working with lawmakers on both sides of the aisle to lower cost and improve public education. I look forward to continue to work with him to deliver for Virginians and excited to introduce him to the body. Madam President. Thank you Senator for that introduction and welcome to Congressman Windman. Thank you for joining us this morning in the Senate gallery. Senators,

[00:44:53] I ask that we give the warm welcome of the Senate to our distinguished visitor. the chair recognizes the senator from king george thank you madam president ross for an introduction the senator has the floor um madam president you may not have a green sheet uh yet because i did not have one but i i would like to bring to the attention in the gallery to the members the

[00:45:27] presence of jennifer nay jennifer serves as a training manager at nestle perina pet care in king william county and she leads employee training and development programs she also extends her leadership well beyond that and has a commitment to advancing women in manufacturing across the commonwealth through mentorship advocacy and service and i bring that up because in recognition of her outstanding leadership and professional excellence jennifer was named the 2025 virginia woman of the year by women in manufacturing virginia

[00:46:06] which is the organization's highest individual honor and by senate joint resolution 66 the general assembly will soon formally commend her for those achievements and other things and really recognize her for the impactful service that she's made in virginia's manufacturing workforce and with that madam president i would hope that we would offer her the warm welcome of the senate i thank the senator for that introduction and senator i do believe your your guest is not

[00:46:40] yet in the gallery but uh senators i ask that we give the warm welcome of the senate uh to our distinguished visitor the chair recognizes the senator from roanoke madam president i rise for introduction the senator has the floor thank you madam president today at the capitol we have many members of the Virginia Manufacturers Association of which the center from

[00:47:16] King George just referenced some including folks from Prestar which is located in Christiansburg in Montgomery County and Prestar recently won an award for best in show at their conference and they won the distinguished honor of being named the manufacturer of the coolest thing made in Virginia which that's wonderful that they were deemed that by their peers the fellow manufacturers later this year we'll also be recognizing them for their achievements as a general assembly through resolution and I ask that you give them one welcome as they're here at the Capitol today I thank the senator

[00:47:54] for that introduction if our guests from the Virginia Manufacturers Association will please rise welcome to the Senate gallery and thank you so much for all that you contribute to Virginia to our economies and to to our workforce we appreciate all that you do and thank you for for being here today senators I ask that we give the warm welcome of the Senate to the Virgin to the representatives of the Virginia manufacturers Association the chair

[00:48:34] recognizes the senator from from Tazewell thank you madam president I rise for the purpose of an introduction. The Senator has the floor. Madam President, it is my privilege to recognize the family of my seatmate, the Senator from Shenandoah, Senator Timmy French.

[00:48:58] His family is in the gallery today, and if they could stand. So joining us in the gallery today is the Senator French's oldest son, Tyler French, who works alongside his father at French Brothers dairy Tyler lives in Mount Jackson with his wife Megan who works as an intake officer for the Department of Juvenile Justice in Shenandoah County also join us in the gallery is Senator French's middle son tab French who works as a salesman for Helena Agra enterprises based in Warsaw and currently lives in

[00:49:38] Glen Allen with his new wife Carly but most importantly Tyler and Megan have also brought their 18 month old twin boys silas and styles and being a father of twins my you have my condolences but madam president i ask that you would give them the warm welcome of the senate it's a privilege to have them here in the gallery in the senate today thank you senator for that introduction and welcome to the family of Senator from Shenandoah. Some of us

[00:50:18] have had the privilege of touring the French farms and seeing the hard work that is happening and especially the innovation that is happening in the dairy industry so we greatly appreciate you being here. Welcome to Tyler, to to Megan, to Tab, to Silas and the Stylous, Stiles.

[00:50:40] Welcome to the entire family. Thank you so much for joining us today in the Senate Gallery. Senators, I ask that we give the warm welcome of the Senate to the family of the Senator from Shenandoah.

[00:51:01] The chair recognizes the junior senator from Virginia Beach. - Good afternoon, Madam President. Rise for an introduction. - The Senator has the floor. - Thank you, Madam President.

[00:51:16] Today in the gallery we have members of the Hampton Roads Transit, one that I was happy to serve as commissioner of. Today they're advocating on behalf of Hampton Roads, which they serve over 1.7 million people.

[00:51:32] And Madam President, I ask that the Senate give them a warm welcome. I thank the Senator for that introduction and thank you to the members of the Hampton Roads Transit. for joining us today and for the work that you do on behalf of so many Virginians and especially those who live in the Hampton

Roads area. Senators I ask that we give the warm welcome of the Senate to the representatives of the Hampton Roads Transit. The chair recognizes the senior senator from

[00:52:10] Henrico. Thank you Madam President. Madam President I rise for the purpose of an introduction. The senator has the floor. Thank you Madam President. Madam president members of the senate in the gallery today we we have members of the virginia transit association uh in 2025 the commonwealth public transportation network uh handled nearly 145 million trips generated over 11 billion economic benefits for the state and prevented the release

[00:52:43] of nearly 90 000 plus metric tons of greenhouse gases the public transit transportation keeps life affordable for our commonwealth while keeping our economy and our environment moving forward i hope you'll join members of the vta tonight at richmond's historic main street station at 5 30 p.m for their annual transit and rail barbecue bash uh madam president please uh

[00:53:16] give the uh members of the commonwealth transit association and in the community a warm senate welcome. I thank the senator for that introduction and welcome to the Virginia Transit Leadership Institute. All of the representatives from Virginia Transit Authority, thank you for the service, the tremendous service that you provide to our businesses, our communities, and so many Virginians who count on the services of our Transit Authority to make sure that we literally get the job done. Thank you again and senators I ask that we give the warm welcome of the Senate to

[00:53:56] the Virginia Transit Authority the chair recognizes the senator from Rockingham thank you madam president rise for an introduction the senator has the floor madam president we're joined in the gallery today by representatives of the Virginia Tech Corps cadets if they would kindly rise we are joined by Commandant Major General William Seeley, Corps Regimental Commander Cadet Robert Waugh,

[00:54:33] 4th Battalion Commander Cadet Archie Hill, Regimental Operations Officer Cadet Aidan Smallwood, Regimental Sergeant Major Liam Garris, Madam President, Virginia Tech's Corps of Cadets boast over 1,400 cadets in Blacksburg, the largest Corps formation since 1965, The Corps of Cadets prepares cadets for a lifetime of service and leadership in the military and beyond, and is the largest non-service academy commissioning source for the U.S. military with a commissioning rate of 85%.

[00:55:12] And in the spirit of UTPROSM, service to the Commonwealth is a cornerstone of the cadet experience, with cadets providing over 8,000 hours of community service last academic year. So, Madam President, I would ask you to extend the warm welcome to the Senate to these representatives of the Virginia Tech Corps of Cadets.

[00:55:34] I thank the Senator for that introduction and welcome to the Virginia Tech Corps of Cadets. Thank you for all of the leadership skills that you are representing for so many of our communities and especially the community of Virginia Tech.

[00:55:52] you uh for the the leadership that you all provide and senators i ask that we give the warm welcome of the senate to the virginia tech corps of cadets is there any other business for the morning hour the clerk will call the calendar senate calendar from monday february 2nd 2026 regular calendar

[00:56:29] house bills on third reading house bill 612 a bill to provide for the submission to the voters a proposed amendment to Section 15-A of Article 1 of the Constitution of Virginia relating to marriage between two adult persons repeal of same-sex marriage prohibition.

[00:56:50] The chair recognizes the senator from Alexandria. Thank you, Madam President. I move the bill pass in speaking to that motion. The senator has the floor. This has plain spoken language to go before the voters on the marriage equality amendment to make it clear that it would remove the ban on same sex marriage and affirm that two adults may marry regardless of sex, gender or race and require that all legally valid marriages be treated equally under the law.

[00:57:19] So I again renew my motion that the bill pass. The question is, shall House Bill 612 pass? All in favor of the motion will record their votes aye, those opposed no.

[00:57:35] Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? any Senators desire to change their votes. The Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 24, noes 16. Ayes 24, noes 16. House Bill 612 passes. House Bill 781, a bill to provide for the submission to the voters of a proposed amendment to the Constitution of Virginia by adding in Article 1 a section number 11-A relating to fundamental right to reproductive freedom reported for the Committee on

[00:58:14] privileges in elections. The chair recognizes the senator from Northern Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. I move the bill pass and speaking to the bill. The senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. This is exactly the same as a bill that we've already passed on a party line vote. It is the ballot language for the constitutional amendment associated with

[00:58:41] hr1 and sj1 and i move the bill pass the question is shall house bill 781 pass all in favor of the motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll ayes 21 Noes 19. Ayes 21. Noes 19. House Bill 781 passes. House Bill 963. A bill to provide for the submission

[00:59:21] to the voters of a proposed amendment to section 1 of the article 2 of the Constitution of Virginia relaying qualifications of voters right to vote persons not entitled to vote. Reported from the Committee on Privileges and Elections. The chair recognizes the senator from Hampton. Thank you, Madam President. I move the HB 963 pass and speaking to that. The senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. HB 963 is the exact same as Senate Joint Resolution 2 relative to the restoration of the right to vote and it's the exact same so I move that that bill pass.

[00:59:58] The question is, shall House Bill 963 pass? All in favor of the motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their votes.

[01:00:15] The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 21, Nose 19. Ayes 21, Nose 19. House Bill 963 passes. Uncontested calendar Senate bills on third reading. The chair recognizes the senator from Eastern Fairfax.

[01:00:33] Madam President, I move that all the Senate bills on third reading and the uncontested calendar on pages 3 through 6, Senate bills 47 through 719 be placed on their final passage in the block. Any senator desiring to move the bill from the block should do so after the clerk has read the number of the bill. The question is, shall the Senate bills on the uncontested calendar, third reading, pages 3 through 6, Senate Bill 47 through Senate Bill 719, be placed upon their final passage in a block, with the understanding that any senator desiring to remove a bill from the block will do so after the clerk has read the number of the bill?

[01:01:09] All in favor of the motion, we'll say aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The motion is agreed to. The bills are now before us in the block. The clerk will read the number of the bills. Senate Bill 47, Senate Bill 55, Senate Bill 88, Senate Bill 149, Senate Bill 181, Senate Bill 285, Senate Bill 302, Senate Bill 522, Senate Bill 719.

[01:01:46] The question is, the senator from Roanoke. Madam President, can Senate Bill 302 please come out of the block? Senate Bill 302 on page 5 is out of the block.

[01:02:03] The question is, shall the bills in the block pass, that is, all bills except for Senate Bill 302 on page 5? All in favor of the passage of the bills will record their votes, aye.

[01:02:21] Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 40, noes zero.

[01:02:39] Ayes 40, noes zero. The bills in the block pass. Senate Bill 302. The chair recognizes the senator from Isle of Wight. Thank you, Madam President. I think the bill title is very self-explanatory, but I would move that the bill shall pass.

[01:03:01] Senator from Roanoke. Madam President, speaking very briefly. The senator has the floor. Madam President, this product is world famous. Everyone knows Virginia makes the best. don't believe that we should pass something on to the customers to make them already know what we already know so madam president that's why I respectfully vote against this bill this is I have every other time because I don't think there's anyone that has any less knowledge about how great this fine

[01:03:32] product is thank you madam president the question is senator senator from Isle of Wight you madam president just breaking briefly to the comment on the bill that this is a self-imposed check-off that the peanut farmers requests to market their product far and wide outside of Virginia's confines and therefore I would move that the bill pass. The question is shall Senate Bill 302 pass all in favor of the

[01:04:06] motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll. Ayes 39 noes 1. Ayes 39, noes 1. Senate Bill 302 passes. Regular calendar, Senate bills on third reading.

[01:04:35] Senate Bill 297, a bill relating to the use of photo speed monitoring devices repealed. There is a floor substitute. The chair recognizes the senator from Lynchburg. Thank you, Madam President, and I will indulge the body's patience for a little while as we move to reconsider. I would like to reconsider the vote by which the bill was ordered to be engrossed and advanced to its third reading. The question is, shall we reconsider the vote by which the bill,

[01:05:14] Senate Bill 3, I'm sorry, Senate Bill 297. I'm making things very simple when we get to it.

[01:05:44] Oh, did I break the whole system? Ah, well. Senate will be at ease temporarily. Or I'll take it by,

[01:05:50] y'all do both. The Senate will return to order. The Senator from Lynchburg, would you like to

[01:07:46] restate your motion, Senator? Thank you, Madam President. Yes, I would move that we reconsider the vote by which this bill was ordered to be engrossed and advanced to its third reading. The question is, shall the vote by which Senate Bill 297 was ordered to be engrossed and advanced to his third reading be reconsidered all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire

[01:08:24] to change their votes the clerk will close the roll ayes 38 no zero ayes 38 no zero the motion by which the vote the vote by which the bill was in order to be engrossed and advanced is now reconsidered now madam president i would move that we waive the reading of the floor substitute the question is shall we waive the reading of the floor substitute all in favor of that motion we'll say aye any opposed no the ayes have it the reading of the floor substitute is waived

[01:09:02] madam president explaining the substitute the senate the senator has the floor thank you madam present. All right, ladies and gentlemen of the Senate, I have withdrawn the full repeal. This is the speed light. This is photos for work zones and school zones. So these are just the camera speeding tickets. And so the only changes occur at lines 110 through 112, which states that the vendor shall not be allowed to impose any additional fee including administrative fee

[01:09:42] to collect the civil penalty so what i have learned from the companies is there's a hundred dollar civil penalty and the locality pays the vendor twelve dollars out of that there had been rumors and anecdotes that they were charging people more to go to court to challenge these tickets i've been advised that that is not the case but in any event this is in there so that if you choose to exercise your constitutional rights they cannot charge you an extra administrative fee

[01:10:15] to go to court to challenge the ticket that is the that is 110 through 112. you want her to be able able to charge you extra? Okay. And then at the back on lines, section K 139 through 148, what we do is we add in some reporting requirements that had not been in place for these tickets.

[01:10:42] And it requires them to tell us the number of tickets, the total amount of money that the locality receives and most importantly how the locality is using the funds generated by the photo speed monitoring device and also the total amount of money paid to the private vendor and the cost of collection activities related to collecting these as it might apply to the people charged with these violations. So what we are doing now is getting much more in-depth reporting from the

[01:11:18] localities as to how much they're charging our drivers versus how much they're paying to the vendors, but more importantly, how they're using the money. And I think you'll see some other bills coming over from the House that are going to require that this money be used for public safety and transportation. So I think this will blend well with that. So that is my explanation of the substitute and with that madam president i would ask that we engross and advance the substitute

[01:11:50] to its third reading senator uh we must first agree to the floor substitute did the senator from prince william the motion the question is madame president senator from charlottesville would the gentleman from lynchburg yield for a question yes madame president the senator yields Does the gentleman envision the localities would just have to say that the money is going to the general fund or does a gentleman expect a breakdown as to how the money is spent?

[01:12:25] Senator from Lynchburg. Madam President, Senator from Charlottesville. I think they're going to have to provide what they're doing with it. If it's just going to their general fund, they'll say it's deposited in our general fund. If it goes to a literary fund, it will say it's going to the literary fund. If it's going to parks and rec, they would say so.

[01:12:43] but I think there's another bill that's going to address that and then we will know thank you so with that I move that we adopt the substitute thank you senator the question is shall the floor substitute that's now in front of us be agreed to all in favor of that motion we'll say aye any opposed no the ayes have

it the floor substitute is agreed to senator from Lynchburg yes now madam Madam President, I would ask that we engross and advance the bill to its third constitutional reading.

[01:13:19] Madam President. Senior Senator from Prince William. I move that bill go by for the day to review of any fiscal impact before it advances. Thank you. Before it advances. Without objection, the bill will go by for the day. The substitute goes by for the day, which is what I was going to do.

[01:13:37] The substitute. Bill 306, a bill relating to use of violation in monitoring systems to enforce traffic light signals and certain traffic control devices, repeal.

[01:13:55] And there is a floor substitute. The chair recognizes the senator from Lynchburg. Yes, same procedure as we did on the last bill. This is for the photo reds. Madam President, I would ask that we reconsider the vote by which this bill was ordered to engrossed and advanced to its third constitutional reading. The question is, shall the vote by which Senate Bill 306 was ordered to be engrossed and advanced to its third reading be reconsidered? All in favor of that motion will record their votes. Aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote?

[01:14:33] Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 40, noes 0. Ayes 40, noes 0. The vote by which the bill was ordered to be engrossed and advanced has been reconsidered. Senator from Lynchburg. Madam President, I move that we waive the reading of the floor substitute. The question is, shall we now waive the reading of the floor substitute? All in favor of the motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The reading of the floor substitute is waived. Senator from

[01:15:11] Lynchburg. Now, Madam President, I would ask that we agree to the floor substitute and explaining the changes are just like what we discussed in the prior bill. The Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. We're going to prevent them from charging any extra administrative fees to people who were charged with the violations other than whatever the applicable court costs would be. And the localities are going to have to, with the photo reds, there were no reporting requirements. So these are found on lines 306 through 315. So they're going to have to tell us

[01:15:46] the number of summons issued, how they're prosecuted, the number of successful prosecutions, the amount of money collected, the amount retained by the locality, and how locality use the funds generated, and the total amount paid to the private vendors. So this will just give us, which we did not have before on stoplights, some indication of how much money is being generated by localities and what they're doing with the money. And with that, I would ask that we agree to the floor substitute. Thank you, Senator. The question is, shall we now agree

[01:16:26] to the floor substitute? All in favor of the motion, we'll say aye. Aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The floor substitute is agreed to. Now, Madam President, I would ask that the

[01:16:38] bill go by for the day. Without objection. Yes. Floor substitute go by for the day. Without objection. SB 306 with its substitute goes by for the day. Senate bill 52. A bill relating to voter registration, regular periodic review of registration records, 90 day quiet period before all primary and general elections. The chair recognizes the junior senator from Virginia Beach. Thank you Madam President. I move the bill The senator has the floor.

[01:17:13] Thank you, Madam President. SB 52, it's just a bill that increases time allowed for voters to rectify their voter registration records from 14 days to 28 days after notice of their record purge is mailed

to them. This legislation does not end voter maintenance.

[01:17:31] It will simply show that any program designed to systematically remove ineligible voters from the voter registration system, system that it must occur in a later than 90 days before primary or general election the bill does not prevent removing names at the registrants request or removing names as allowed by existing law due to criminal conviction mental incapacity or death it does not prevent corrections to registration records under current law right of a president with that I move the bill pass the question is shall Senate bill 52 pass all in favor of that motion will

[01:18:06] record their votes, aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 21, noes 19. Ayes 21, noes 19. Senate Bill 52 passes. Senate Bill 126, a bill relating to elections, primary election, when filings to be made, extension for incumbents, failure to file.

[01:18:40] The chair recognizes the senator from Western Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. I move the bill pass in speaking to that. The senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. This is a very straightforward bill that allows the filing deadline for primary elections for a particular elected office to be extended by five days when the incumbent of that office does not file by the deadline or files and then withdraws their filing.

[01:19:10] This bill will really bolster democracy and allow the people to decide who their elected officials are. And we have seen, unfortunately, both sides of the aisle where incumbents have waited until the very last minute to say they are not running.

[01:19:33] Then folks don't have the time to get the signatures that they need to file. But somebody who knew about it swoops right in and is ready at that last moment. So I really hope we can get more bipartisan support on this one.

[01:19:51] It did come out narrowly with a bipartisan vote. But this is really about ensuring that people choose their elected officials and that in the Commonwealth there are no heirs to any elected office. And with that, I hope the bill passes.

[01:20:09] The question is, "Shall Senate Bill 126 pass?" All in favor of that motion will record their votes, aye, those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted?

[01:20:26] Do any senators desire to change their votes? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 23, noes 17. Ayes 23, noes 17. Senate Bill 126 passes.

[01:20:44] Senate Bill 136, a bill relating to decreasing probation period. The chair recognizes the senator from Chesapeake. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move the bill pass in speaking to that bill.

[01:21:01] The senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. In 2025, I carried this bill successfully through this legislature, and it went on to the governor's desk. He amended the bill to put together a stakeholder work group over the interim, and it was led by the Department of Corrections.

[01:21:18] this group brought together various agencies and subject matter experts and the product of their collaboration is this bill before you senate bill 136. this legislation reflects the recommendation of this group and again i ask the bill pass the question is shall senate bill 136 pass all in favor of that motion

will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the role

[01:21:54] ayes 31 noes 9 ayes 31 noes 9 senate bill 136 passes senate bill 176 a bill related to elections conduct of election rated choice voting ranked choice voting locally elected officers report - The chair recognizes the senator from Western Henrico.

[01:22:21] - Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move passage of the bill and speak into that motion. - The senator has the floor. - Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, members of the body, this bill does three things. One, is it institutes technical changes, which is something that we voted on two years ago that were based on a Yunkin Department of Elections report on how ranked choice voting was going and the places doing it.

[01:22:40] Two, it expands the localities that can do this to towns, which was originally intended in the original legislation. And then three, it gets rid of the sunset clause so that localities can choose to do this if they would like. That is what the bill does. I renew my motion.

[01:22:58] The question is, shall Senate Bill 176 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote?

[01:23:14] The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 21, noes 19. Ayes 21, Nose 19, Senate Bill 176 passes. Senate Bill 311, a bill to relate to marriage between two adult persons to repeal the same-sex marriage prohibitions.

[01:23:37] The chair recognizes the senator from Alexandria. Thank you, Madam President. I move the bill pass. And speaking to the bill. The senator has the floor. This is the Senate cognate of the House bill we just passed earlier that puts the marriage equality amendment on the ballot before the voters.

[01:23:53] I move the bill pass. The question is, shall Senate bill 311 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators wish to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 25, noes 15. Ayes 25, noes 15.

[01:24:21] Senate bill 311 passes Senate bill 438 a bill to amend a bill relating to elections alternate voting in person available the second Sunday before all elections the chair recognizes the senior senator from Henrico thank you madam president matter president I move the bill passes speaking to that the senator has the floor thank you madam president this bill requires all localities in the Commonwealth to offer Sunday voting in-person absentee on the Second and third Sunday immediately preceding elections between the hours of 11:00 and 5:00 p.m.. And I renew my motion

[01:24:58] The question is shall Senate bill 438 pass all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed No, or the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their votes the clerk will close the roll

[01:25:19] Ayes 21 noes 19. Ayes 21 noes 19. Senate bill 438 passes. Senate bill 582. A bill relating to elections, absentee, and provisional ballots, process and timing for rejected absentee ballot applications, returned absentee ballots, and rejected provisional ballots. The chair recognizes the senator from Central Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. I move that the bill pass and speaking to that motion. The senator has the floor.

[01:25:55] Thank you, Madam President. Senate Bill 582, this bill is a clean-up bill to our ballot curing process to account for the changes we have made in recent years regarding absentee ballot and same-day registration with provisional ballots. It does a couple things for the absentee ballots and provisional ballots. We are moving the cure process to the Monday after the election and the other part it does is that any ballots that are rejected that there's adequate time for those to be cured as well as ideally

[01:26:29] provisional ballots to be made available on the website no later than the noon on the Wednesday after the election and I renew my motion that we pass the bill the question is shall Senate bill 582 pass all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote

[01:27:00] the clerk will close the roll it's 21 nose 19 eyes 21 nose 19 Senate bill 582 passes uncontested calendar Senate bills on second reading the chair recognize the chair recognizes the senator from Alexandria thank you madam president I move that all Senate bills on the second reading on the uncontested calendar on pages 10 through 15, Senate Bill 165 through Senate Bill 713, be advanced to their engrossment and third reading in the block after the adoption

[01:27:36] of the amendments thereto. Any senator desiring to remove a bill from the block, please do so after the clerk has read the number of the bill. The question is, shall all Senate bills on their second reading on the uncontested calendar on pages 10 through 15 Senate Bill 165 through Senate Bill 713 be engrossed and advanced to their third reading in the block after the adoption of any amendments thereto that any senator desiring to remove a bill from the block will do so after the clerk has read the number of the bill. All in favor of this motion will say aye. Any opposed

[01:28:15] No the ayes have it the motion is agreed to the clerk will now read the number of the bills Senate bill 165 Reported from the committee on general laws and technology with amendment the chair recognizes the senior senator from Prince William Thank You madam president move the amendment be agreed to the question is shall the amendment from the committee on general laws and technology be agreed to. All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it.

[01:28:45] The amendment is agreed to. Senate bill 184 reported from the Committee on General Laws and Technology with a substitute. The chair recognizes the senator from Norfolk. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move that the committee substitute be agreed to.

[01:29:01] The question is: Shall the substitute from the Committee on General Laws and Technology be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye, any opposed no, the ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to. Senate Bill 210 reported from the Committee on Education and Health.

[01:29:20] Senate Bill 269 reported from the Committee on General Laws and Technology with a substitute. The chair recognizes the senator from Arlington. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move that the substitute be agreed to. The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee on General Laws and Technology be agreed to. All in favor of that motion, we'll say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to. Senate Bill 300, reported from the Committee on General Laws and Technology.

[01:29:52] Senate Bill 309, reported from the Committee on Education and Health. Senate Bill 325, reported from the Committee on General Laws and Technology. Senate Bill 338, reported from the Committee on general laws and technology. Senate Bill 392, reported from the Committee on Education

and Health with a substitute. The chair recognizes the senator from Isle of Wight. Thank you, Madam President. I move the committee to substitute. The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee on Education and Health be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye.

[01:30:30] Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to. Senate Bill 439, reported from the Committee on Education and Health. Senate Bill 577, reported from the Committee on General Laws and Technology with a substitute. The chair recognizes the senator from Orange. Thank you, Madam President. I would move the committee substitute be agreed to. The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee on General Laws and Technology be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to. Senate Bill

[01:31:06] Senate Bill 592 reported from the Committee on Education and Health. Senate Bill 597 reported from the Committee on General Laws and Technology with a substitute. The Chair recognizes the Senator from Eastern Henrico.

[01:31:21] Thank you, Madam President. I move the committee substitute. The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee on General Laws and Technology be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to. Senate Bill 613, reported from the Committee on General Laws and Technology.

[01:31:40] Senate Bill 633, reported from the Committee on Education and Health, with a substitute. The chair recognizes the junior senator from Loudoun. Thank you, Madam President. I move that the committee substitute be agreed to. The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee on Education and Health be agreed to?

[01:31:58] All in favor of that motion, we'll say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to. bill 683 reported from the committee on education and health with an amendment the chair recognizes the senator from orange thank you madam president I now move the committee amendment be agreed to the question is shall the amendment from the committee on education and health be agreed to all in favor of that motion we'll say aye any opposed no the ayes have it the amendment is agreed to Senate bill 699 reported from the committee on general laws and technology Senate Bill 706, reported from the Committee on Education and Health.

[01:32:38] Senate Bill 713, reported from the Committee for Courts of Justice, with a substitute. The chair recognizes the senator from Charlottesville. Madam President, I move the committee substitute be agreed to. The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee for Courts of Justice be agreed to?

[01:32:55] All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The substitute is agreed to. The question is, shall the Senate bills be engrossed in advance to their third reading? All in favor of this motion will say aye.

[01:33:11] Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The bills are now engrossed in advance to their third reading. Regular calendar, Senate bills on second reading. Senate Bill 496, a bill relating to secure storage of handguns, unattended locked vehicle penalty, Reported from the Committee for Courts of Justice with a substitute, and there are five floor amendments.

[01:33:40] The chair recognizes the senior senator from Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. I move that the bill go by for the day. Without objection, Senate Bill 496 goes by for the day. Senate Bill 350, a bill relating to elections, absentee voting, processing, and counting ballots prior to the close of polls.

[01:34:02] Reported from the Committee on Privileges and Elections. The chair recognizes the senator from Western, Prince William. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I'd like to take this bill by for the day as the floor amendment should be ready to go by tomorrow.

[01:34:19] Without objection, Senate Bill 350 goes by for the day. Senate Bill 22, a bill relating to Board of Nursing continuing education requirements reported from the Committee on Privilege on Education and Health with a substitute.

[01:34:35] The chair recognizes the senator from Hampton. Madame President, I move that the substitute be agreed to. The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee on Education and Health be agreed to?

[01:34:50] All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to. Senator from Hampton. Thank you, Madame President. I now move that the bill be engrossed in advance to its third reading. The question is, shall Senate Bill 22 now be engrossed in advance to its third reading?

[01:35:10] All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. Senate Bill 22 is engrossed in advance. Senate Bill 48, a bill relating to Virginia Residential Landlord and Tenant Act, Landlord Remedies, Noncompliance with Rental Agreement, Mandatory Waiting Period, reported from the Committee on General Laws and Technology.

[01:35:34] The chair recognizes the junior senator from Virginia Beach. Thank you, Madam President. I move the bill be engrossed in advance. This is third reading. The question is, shall Senate Bill 48 be engrossed in advance to its third reading? All in favor of the motion will say aye. Any opposed, no.

[01:35:51] The ayes have it. Senate Bill 48 is engrossed in advance. Senate Bill 63, a bill relating to Board of Education requirements for graduation with an advanced studies diploma, simultaneous completion of international baccalaureate diploma, and advanced studies diploma, approval of alternatives for certain credit requirements regulation reported from the committee on education and health with the substitute the chair recognizes the senator from central fairfax thank you madam president i move that the committee substitute be agreed to

[01:36:28] the question is shall the substitute from the committee on education and health be agreed to all in favor of that motion we'll say aye any opposed no the eyes have it the committee substitute is agreed to senator from central fairfax madam president i move that the bill be engrossed and advanced to its third reading the question is shall senate bill 63 now be engrossed and advanced to its third reading all in favor of that motion will say aye any opposed no the bill is engrossed and advanced senate bill 183 a bill to direct the board of health to

[01:37:05] promulgate regulations requiring restaurants to label any delivery or carry out food containing major food allergens reported from the committee on education and health with a substitute the chair recognizes the senator from norfolk thank you madam president i move that the committee substitute be agreed to the question is shall the substitute from the committee on education and health be agreed to all in favor of that motion we'll say aye any opposed no the ayes have it the substitute is agreed to senator from norfolk thank you madam president i move that the bill

[01:37:42] be engrossed and passed on to his third constitutional reading the question is shall senate bill 183 now be engrossed and advanced to his third reading all in favor of that motion will say aye any

opposed no the bill is engrossed and advanced senate bill 194 a bill to direct the board of medicine and the board of nursing to establish continuing education requirements on the electronic death registration system for and require an attestation to the requirements

[01:38:17] of timely signing of death certificates by physicians and advanced practice registered nurses authorized to practice independently reported from the committee on education and health with a substitute the chair recognizes the senator from norfolk thank you madam president i move that the committee substitute be agreed to the question is shall the substitute from the committee on education and health be agreed to all in favor of that motion will say aye any opposed no the eyes have it the substitute is agreed to senator from norfolk thank you madam president madam president i move that the bill be engrossed and advanced to its third constitutional

[01:38:54] reading the question is shall senate bill 194 now be engrossed and advanced to its third reading all in favor of that motion will say aye any opposed no the bill is engrossed and advanced senate bill Bill 232, a bill relating to Consumer Data Protection Act prohibitions and duties relating to minors, reporting from the Committee on General Laws and Technology.

[01:39:22] The chair recognizes the senior senator from Prince William. Thank you, Madam President. I move that this bill be recommitted to the Committee on General Laws and Technology and I've spoken with the patron, thank you. The question is, shall Senate Bill 232 be recommitted to the Committee for General Laws and technology. All in favor of that motion, we'll say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The bill is recommitted. Senate Bill 248, a bill relating to restaurants, food allergy awareness notice required, reported from the Committee on Education and Health. The chair

[01:39:59] recognizes the junior senator from Loudoun. Thank you, Madam President. I move Senate Bill 248 be engrossed and advanced to the third reading. The question is, shall Senate Bill 248 now be engrossed and advanced to its third reading? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and advanced. Senate Bill 290, a bill relating to Virginia Residential Landlord and Tenant Act Enforcement by Localities, reported from the Committee on General Laws and

[01:40:33] Technology. The chair recognizes the senator from Eastern Henrico. Thank you so much, Madam President. I move the bill be engrossed in advance to its third reading. The question is, shall Senate Bill 290 now be engrossed in advance to its third reading? All in favor of that motion, we'll say aye.

[01:40:50] We'll say aye. Aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The bill is engrossed in advance. Senate Bill 341, a bill relating to private elementary and secondary schools' students' code of conduct, policies relating to bullying and cyberbullying prevention and parental notification requirements reported from the Committee on Education and Health.

[01:41:17] The chair recognizes the senator from Northern Fairfax. Madam President, I move the bill be engrossed in advance to its third reading. The question is, shall Senate Bill 341 now be engrossed in advance to its third reading? All in favor of the motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it.

[01:41:35] Senate Bill 341 is engrossed in advance. Senate bill 351 a bill relating to certain civil arrests prohibited in courthouses penalty Reported from the committee for courts of justice with the substitute the chair recognizes the senator from central Fairfax Thank You madam president I move that the committee substitute be agreed to the question is shall the substitute from the committee for courts of justice Be agreed to all in favor of that motion will say aye hi any opposed No, the ayes have it. The

substitute is agreed to. Senator from Central Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. I move that the bill be engrossed and advanced to its third reading. The question

[01:42:14] is, shall Senate Bill 351 now be engrossed and advanced to its third reading? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and advanced. Senate Bill 402, a bill relating to residential property owners, insurance policies, roofing services by contractors, prohibited practices and consumer protection. The chair recognizes the senator from Eastern Fairfax. For the committee on general laws and technology with amendments. Madam President, I move the committee amendments. The question is shall the amendments from the committee on general laws and technology be

[01:42:54] agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The committee amendments are agreed to. Senator from Eastern Fairfax. move the bill be engrossed and advanced to its third reading the question is shall Senate bill 402 now be engrossed in advance to his third reading all in favor of that motion will say aye any opposed no the ayes have it the bill is engrossed and advanced Senate bill 427 a bill relating to high school graduation requirements history and social studies credits certain substitutions permitted reported from the committee on education and health

[01:43:33] with amendment the chair recognizes the senior senator from Henrico thank you madam president madam president I move that the committee amendments be agreed to the question is shall the amendment from the committee on education and health be agreed to all in favor of the motion will say aye any opposed no the eyes have it the committee amendment is agreed to senator senior senator from Henrico thank you madam president madam president I move that the bill be engrossed and moved to its and advanced to its third constitutional reading the question is shall Senate bill 427 now be engrossed and advanced to his third

[01:44:09] reading all in favor of the motion will say aye any opposed no the ayes have it the bill is engrossed and advanced Senate bill 493 a bill relating to consumer protection automatic renewal or continuous service offers disclosure and cancellation reported from the committee on general laws and technology with amendments. The chair recognizes the senator from Western Fairfax. Madam President I ask that we pass this bill by for the day seems like the floor amendment is incomplete that was given to us like to work on it. Without

[01:44:48] objection Senate bill 493 goes by for the day. Senate bill 701 a bill relating to Virginia Lottery Disclosure of Identity of Winners, reported from the Committee on General Laws and Technology. The chair recognizes the senator from Alexandria. Madam President, I move the bill be engrossed in advance to its third reading. The question is, shall Senate Bill 701 now be engrossed in advance to a third reading? All in favor of the motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The

[01:45:27] ayes have it. The bill is engrossed and advanced. Senate Bill 765, a bill relating to charitable gaming poker events, reported from the Committee on General Laws and Technology with the substitute. The chair recognizes the senator from City of Richmond. Madam President, I move the committee substitute be agreed to.

[01:45:48] The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee on General Laws and Technology be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Aye. Any opposed, no the ayes have it the committee substitute is agreed to senator from Richmond madam president senator senior senator from Prince William I know we're on second read but with the patron yield for a question well the senator from

Richmond City yield yes I'll yield senior senator from Prince William thank you madam president would this be the senator's first bill in the Senate on

[01:46:23] on third read tomorrow senator from richmond city uh madam madam president i would say in this particular paradigm yes it is i thank the senator for his paradigm madam president uh senator from richmond city thank you madam president i move uh the bill be engrossed and advanced for its third reading the question is shall senate bill 765 now be engrossed

[01:46:58] in advance to his third reading all in favor of that motion will say aye any opposed no it seems to me the nose have it the chair is not certain shall we do that again all in favor of the motion will say aye aye any opposed no i hear some clearing of the throats but no official nose senate bill 765 is now engrossed and advanced thank you madam president the chair recognizes

[01:47:33] the senator from eastern fairfax ben president move all the senate bills on first reading on the uncontested regular counters pages 22 through 30 senate bills 14 to 663 the rules be suspended in the first constitutional reading of the titles be dispensed with the question is shall the rules be suspended in the first constitutional reading of the titles of the senate bills on the uncontested and regular calendars pages 22 through 30 senate bill 14 through senate bill 663 be dispensed with all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no

[01:48:09] are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll ayes 40 no zero ayes 40 no zero the reading of the titles is dispensed with senator from eastern fairfax move that all those bills go by for the day the question is shall the senate bills on the uncontested and regular calendars now on their

[01:48:43] second reading be passed by for the day all in favor of that motion we'll say aye those opposed no the ayes have it the bills will go by for the day regular calendar senate joint resolutions on third reading senate joint resolution 60 confirming appointments by the governor of certain persons communicated to the general assembly january 21st 2026 the chair recognizes the junior senator from virginia beach thank you madam president can sj60 go by for today without objection sjr 60 goes by

[01:49:19] for the day senate joint resolution 61 confirming appointments by the governor of certain persons communicated to the general assembly january 23rd 2026 the junior senator from virginia beach thank you madam president can sj 61 go by for today without objection sjr 61 goes by for the day uncontested calendar senate joint resolutions on first reading the chair recognizes the senator from eastern fairfax madam president i move that all the senate resolutions on first reading on

[01:49:55] the uncontested regular counters page 31 sr 12 through 59 that the rules be suspended the first reading of the titles be dispensed with. The question is, shall the rules be suspended in the first reading of the titles of the Senate joint resolutions on the uncontested and regular calendars page 31? SJR 12 through SJR 59 now be waived. All in favor of the motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no.

[01:50:22] Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll. Ayes 40 no 0. Ayes 40 no 0. The reading of the title is waived. Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Move that all those resolutions go by for the day. The question is shall the Senate joint resolutions on the uncontested and regular calendars now on second reading be passed by for the day. All in favor of the motion will say aye.

[01:50:55] Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The resolutions will go by for the day. Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Inquiry to the clerk. Good to see you again. Does that complete today's calendar?

[01:51:11] It's nice to see you again. It does complete the calendar. If you've been locked in a house for six days. Is there any other business to come before the Senate?

[01:51:29] The chair recognizes the senator from Hampton. Thank you, Madam President. I rise on a point of personal privilege. the senator has the floor thank you madam president february 1st marked the beginning of black history month with that this year 2026 marks 100 years since the first negro history week began in 1926. this week focused on the historical efforts to study and celebrate black history life and culture the theme for this year is aptly a century of black history commemorations

[01:52:06] this theme acknowledges the milestone of 100 years of national efforts to recognize black history honoring the legacy of dr carter g woodson a virginian and founder of black history week 100 years ago dr woodson earned the phd from harvard university he was a son of formerly enslaved parents born in new canton virginia in 1875. woodson was denied the privilege of a high school education until he was 20 years old.

[01:52:37] After receiving an undergraduate degree from Beret College, a master's from the University of Chicago, and a doctorate in history from Harvard, he went on to become a high school teacher and ultimately a professor and dean at Howard University.

[01:52:54] Woodson soon learned that the American Historical Association had no interest in black history, although he was a dues-paying member. He was not even allowed to attend their conferences. He then decided to create an institutional structure that made it possible for African-American scholars to study and teach history.

[01:53:15] The Carnegie Foundation, the Rockefeller Foundation, and the Julius Rosenwald Foundation funded his dream of starting such an organization. He and other scholars founded the Association for the Study of Negro Life and History in 1915.

[01:53:33] That organization is now the Association for the Study of African American Life and History and was the impetus for Negro History Week in 1926, which morphed into Black History Month in 1970. Dr. Woodson believed that denying people of their history denies them of their humanity.

[01:53:51] He once stated that those who have no record of what their forebears have accomplished lose the inspiration which comes from the teaching of biography and history. His purpose was to integrate black history into the educational curriculum, public libraries, local churches, and communities across the United States.

[01:54:11] This was not designed to be a symbolic gesture, but a permanent shift in how America viewed and understood itself. For several years now, we have had to listen to the denigration of the history of people of color, fight back efforts to erase and eradicate the history and culture of African American people from the annals of books, museums, and libraries to satisfy the comfort of others while ignoring the reality of history.

[01:54:39] Revisionist history does not eradicate its truth. In 2026, as we pause to honor a century of commemorating Dr. Woodson's legacy, the message is clear and as necessary as ever: Black history is American history.

[01:54:55] In this 250th year of the founding of these United States of America, We can endeavor to continue to form a more perfect union by remembering and recognizing that in commemorating the history of African Americans, we strengthen all of us as a people.

[01:55:11] Thank you, Madam President. Thank you, Senator. The chair recognizes the senior senator from Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. Rise for an announcement. The senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President.

[01:55:27] The time has come, the walrus said, to speak of many things. It's Massey Cancer Center basketball time. And all of us have been contributing $250 a year with a goal of $10,000 prior to this event to help the Massey Cancer Center fight this terrible disease.

[01:55:47] And our coach this year, Coach Sturdivant, is out recruiting folks from all over the Commonwealth to play in this game. And we have, it's just a couple weeks away, and we have tightened up our proxy rules, Madam President, that before anyone can play in this game you will have had to have shaken hands with a state senator prior to the whistle kicking the game on. So we're uh we're ready to go we're ready to repeat last year's great victory and uh 250 bucks do it here do it in my office but please do it. Thank you.

[01:56:19] Those are some arduous rules Senator. Thank you. The chair recognizes uh Senator from Roanoke. Thank you Madam President. I rise for a brief point of personal privilege. The senator has the floor. thank you madam president lucy addison is a name familiar to a lot of folks in the roanoke valley she was born into slavery in 1861 falkier county but she arrived in roanoke in her 20s after she had gone to get educated to become a teacher in philadelphia and in roanoke she quickly made her

[01:56:58] mark and in still in her late 20s at 26 years old she became the first female head of a school right there in Roanoke for black children and unfortunately for her the next year she was displaced by a man and that was unfortunately how it went for her and she had she just continued to do her best and do work for the children for the next 30 years when they came to their senses and gave her the opportunity to be principal again and she did a great job educating

[01:57:35] hundreds of young people in Roanoke and in that situation it was primarily K through eighth grade and finally a new high school was going to be created in Roanoke to educate the black students there and she was taken up in the leadership of that position and she helped the school become accredited almost immediately which was not something that happened everywhere she did an excellent job for them for the school was recognized widely in the valley and she left the school a few years later to retire and when that

[01:58:13] school was now going to be the high school that was going to be created the new high school there was no question on who it should be named for even though no school in Roanoke had ever been named for anyone it was named Lucy Addison High School and Lucy Addison has educated people for decades in her name it's now a middle school but we're very proud in the Roanoke Valley of what Lucy Addison did when she passed away she had no children she had no children to continue her legacy in her family but because of what she had done through the public schools in Roanoke and also for 25 years as the superintendent of Fifth

[01:58:51] Avenue Presbyterian Church in Roanoke as their Sunday school superintendent. There were dozens of educators that all came to the field because of her and so her legacy lived on through the

community and continues to this day and I thank Madam President for that moment. Thank you Senator. The chair recognizes the senator from Eastern Fairfax. Madam President I rise for announcement senator has the floor if I could just ask the democratic members the courts just committee meet me back here for three minutes as soon as we're done I'd appreciate that thank you

[01:59:27] the chair recognizes the senator from Colonial Heights thank you madam president rise for an announcement senator has the floor it's actually going to be senator van Valkenburg and I who are co-coaching the the basketball team so it's going to be bipartisan coaching we are scheduled to have basketball Tuesday nights at MLK Middle School at 7:00 p.m. so if you have your sneakers or basketball shoes please bring them tomorrow if you're the senator from Shenandoah please bring your high top work boots and the the

[02:00:07] basketball game is February 23rd that's three weeks from today so we don't have a whole lot of time to practice we've got one additional former D1 football player now that the senator from Richmond City is in the Senate we hopefully can find somebody else we need a point guard and somebody who can handle the ball so if you if you have an LA who is a good point guard please have him come and give us a hand thank you and please make sure they shake the hand of a sitting senator before they join the team the chair recognizes a

[02:00:44] senator from Northern Fairfax thank you madam president I rise for an announcement. The senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Over the past week or so I've mentioned that there are a group of Buddhist monks who are walking across the south to Washington, D.C., and today is the day that they are in Richmond. So within the next hour we expect that they will be walking along with members of the public up 9th Street. Unfortunately they won't be able to come to the capitol because it's been too icy so the the presentation and the the peace

[02:01:23] gathering that they will be providing for the public will happen at city hall um at three o'clock so um this this will be special in other areas thousands of people have accompanied them they're walking across the bridge up ninth street um i expect that it'll be something that's special and perhaps once in a lifetime for those of us who wish to uh go i will be giving them the presentation of the commendation before the before the peace gathering begins um not in front of everybody else

[02:02:02] and um thank you very much thank you senator the clerk will report any announcements on the desk today monday february the second the committee on court suggests a committee on commerce and labor will meet 15 minutes after adjournment in senate room a gab the finance and appropriations subcommittee on economic development and natural resources will meet at 4 30 p.m senate finance and appropriations room 13th floor gab the northern virginia delegation caucus will meet at 5 p.m house room

[02:02:41] 1010th floor gab tuesday february the third the finance and appropriations subcommittee on general Government will meet 7:30 a.m. the Senate Finance and Appropriations Room 13th Floor GAB. The Finance and Appropriations Subcommittee on Resources will meet at 8 a.m. in Senate Room A General Assembly Building. The Agriculture Conservation and Natural Resources Subcommittee on Water Usage will meet at 8 a.m. Senate Room C GAB. The Committee on Finance and

[02:03:16] Appropriations will meet at 9 a.m. Senate Room A, GAB. The Agriculture, Conservation, and Natural Resources Subcommittee on Companion Animals will meet at 9.30 a.m. in Senate Room C, GAB. The Democratic Caucus will meet at 11.15 a.m. Senate Room 1 of the Capitol. The Republican Caucus will

[02:03:39] meet at 11.30 a.m. in Senate Room 2 of the Capitol. The chair recognizes the senator from portsmouth the chair recognizes the senator from portsmouth thank you madam president madam president i move to the senate do now adjourn until 12 noon tomorrow and the majority can continue this conversation with me in about five minutes the question is shall the senate

[02:04:14] now adjourn until 12 noon tomorrow all in favor of that motion we'll say aye any opposed no the eyes have it the motion is agreed to the senate stands adjourned until 12 noon tomorrow senate

[02:04:41] chamber. This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia, Senate chamber. Be sure to stay connected

[02:08:49] with live sessions, catch up on past meetings, and explore our full archives anytime on the Senate of Virginia's YouTube channel.